Unit 8: Clean Water

Complete exercise solutions — all textbook questions answered (full book, 14 units)

Reading and Critical Thinking — Exercise A (Answers)

Q1. The author uses cause-effect frequently throughout the text. Choose one instance and explain how this pattern helps the reader understand the seriousness of water-related issues.

For example: "In areas where water is scarce or contaminated, people are less likely to practise good hygiene, leading to higher rates of illness and disease." The cause (scarce/contaminated water) and effect (poor hygiene, more disease) pattern makes the seriousness clear by showing exactly how one problem leads to another. Another example: "We are using water at a rate faster than it precipitates to the ground" — the cause (overuse) leads to the effect (depletion of clean water resources).

Q2. Identify a paragraph where the writer presents a problem-solution structure. Do you think the solutions offered are realistic and achievable in the context of Pakistan? Justify your response.

The paragraph beginning "Addressing these challenges requires a multifaceted approach..." presents the problem (scarcity and contamination) and solutions (improved infrastructure, waste management, sustainable use, rainwater harvesting, purification technology). The solutions are realistic for Pakistan because community initiatives like rainwater harvesting and watershed management are low-cost and already used in arid regions, while investment in purification can be supported by government and international organisations. However, they require sustained funding and community participation.

Q3. How does the use of reasons and conclusions in the final paragraphs strengthen the writer's argument? Refer to specific lines in your answer.

The final paragraphs summarise the reasons clean water matters — "Clean water is a fundamental resource that supports human health, environmental sustainability, and economic development" — and conclude that "Ensuring clean water for all is not only a matter of public health but also a critical step towards achieving global prosperity and well-being." This logical structure (reasons leading to a conclusion) makes the argument convincing because the conclusion follows naturally from the evidence given throughout the text.

Q4. Can you find an example where the organisational pattern changes within the same paragraph? What effect does this shift have on the reader's understanding?

In paragraph 6, the pattern shifts from cause-effect (without clean water, farmers struggle, leading to food shortages and higher prices) to problem-solution (investing in clean water infrastructure improves public health and fosters economic stability). The shift moves the reader from understanding the problem to seeing a way forward, which makes the text more persuasive and hopeful.

Q5. Imagine this text were rewritten in a comparison-contrast format comparing countries with water abundance and water scarcity. What new insights might that structure offer?

A comparison-contrast structure would highlight the gap between water-rich and water-poor countries: infrastructure, health outcomes, agricultural productivity, and economic stability. It would show that scarcity is not only natural but also caused by poor management, and it would make the need for investment in water infrastructure more urgent by showing what abundance can achieve.

Q6. Why is it important to distinguish between fact and opinion, or between evidence and generalisation, when reading informational texts like this one? How does it affect your understanding?

Facts (such as WHO statistics on deaths from diarrhoea) can be verified and trusted, while opinions (such as "we mistreat the small fraction of water") express the writer's judgement. Distinguishing them helps the reader evaluate the argument critically and not accept generalisations without evidence. It affects understanding because the reader can separate reliable information from persuasive language.

Q7. What are some community-based initiatives mentioned for improving access to clean drinking water?

Rainwater harvesting, water conservation, and watershed management. These initiatives involve local communities in protecting and managing their water sources and can improve access to clean drinking water at low cost.

Q8. How can investing in clean water infrastructure contribute to global prosperity and well-being?

• Investing in clean water infrastructure improves public health by reducing waterborne diseases, which lowers the economic burden on governments and communities.

• It supports agriculture and food production, stabilising food prices and markets, and protects ecosystems by reducing pollution.

• Thus, ensuring clean water for all is a critical step towards global prosperity and well-being.

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Exercise B — Choose the Correct Option (Answer Key)

No.	Question	Answer
1	What does "fundamental" most likely mean in "Water is fundamental to all forms of life"?	b. essential
2	What does "mistreat" most likely mean in "We mistreat the small fraction of water"?	c. abuse
3	What does "vital" most likely mean in "Clean water... is vital for drinking, cooking, sanitation, and hygiene"?	c. essential
4	What does "contaminated" most likely mean?	b. polluted
5	What does "incidence" most likely mean?	c. occurrence
6	What does "disrupt" most likely mean?	b. destroy (disturb the normal course of)
7	What does "implications" most likely mean?	b. consequences
8	What does "vulnerable" most likely mean?	c. susceptible

Exercise C — Cause and Effect (Answers)

• **1.** "We are using water at a rate faster than it precipitates to the ground." — Cause: human overuse of water. Effect: depletion of clean water resources. It supports the argument by showing that human behaviour is the main threat to clean water.

• **2.** "In areas where water is scarce or contaminated, people are less likely to practise good hygiene, leading to higher rates of illness and disease." — Cause: scarcity/contamination. Effect: poor hygiene and more disease. It supports the argument by linking water quality directly to public health.

Exercise D — Fact or Opinion (Answers)

• 1. "Clean water is a fundamental resource that supports human health, environmental sustainability, and economic development." — **Fact** (supported by evidence throughout the text). 2. "We mistreat the small fraction of water that we have." — **Opinion** (a judgement about human behaviour; "mistreat" is evaluative language). 3. "Investing in clean water infrastructure not only improves public health but also fosters economic stability and growth." — **Fact-based claim** (a reasoned conclusion supported by the text's evidence).

Vocabulary Exercises (Answers)

• **Synonyms and parts of speech (model):** courage (noun) — bravery; perseverance (noun) — persistence; inequality (noun) — disparity; energy (noun) — vitality; magnificent (adjective) — splendid; deteriorate (verb) — worsen; innovative (adjective) — creative; comprehend (verb) — understand; adversity (noun) — hardship.

• **Word maps (model):** Contamination — definition: the act of making something dirty or unsafe; synonyms: pollution, infection; antonyms: purification, sterilisation; sentence: Industrial contamination of the river killed the fish. Scarcity — definition: the state of being in short supply; synonyms: shortage, dearth; antonyms: abundance, plenty; sentence: Water scarcity forced the village to ration supplies. Sanitation — definition: conditions relating to public health, especially clean drinking water and waste disposal; synonyms: hygiene, cleanliness; antonyms: pollution, filth; sentence: Poor sanitation spreads disease. Irrigation — definition: the supply of water to land or crops; synonyms: watering; antonyms: drought; sentence: Irrigation helps farmers grow crops in dry areas.

Grammar — Commonly Confused Words (Answers)

• **Sentences:** stationery — "He bought new stationery for his office." stationary — "The car remained stationary at the traffic light." elicit — "The teacher's question elicited a thoughtful answer." illicit — "The police raided the illicit gambling den." wander — "We wandered through the old streets." wonder — "I wonder what happened to him." latest — "What is the latest news?" last — "This is the last chapter of the book." know — "I know the answer." now — "Come now, be quick." patience — "Learning a language requires patience." patient — "The doctor was patient with the child." adopt — "They decided to adopt a new policy." adapt — "We must adapt to the new system."

Writing Tasks — Model Answers

A. Formal Letter: Complaint about Poor Internet Connectivity on Campus

• **Sender's address:** Hostel No. 3, University Campus, Karachi. **Date:** 13 November 2026. **Receiver:** The Director, IT Services, University Campus, Karachi. **Subject:** Complaint regarding poor internet connectivity on campus.

• **Body:** I am writing to draw your attention to the poor internet connectivity in the hostel and academic blocks. The connection is slow and frequently disconnects, which badly affects our academic work — online lectures, research, and submission of assignments. Despite repeated complaints, the problem persists. I request you to kindly look into the matter and take urgent steps to improve the service so that students are not deprived of their studies.

• **Closing:** I hope for your prompt action in this regard. Yours sincerely, [Name], [Class/Roll No.].

B. Formal Letter: Unclean Drinking Water in Your Area

• **Sender's address:** House No. 12, Street 4, Gulshan-e-Iqbal, Karachi. **Date:** 13 November 2026. **Receiver:** The Municipal Officer, Gulshan Town, Karachi. **Subject:** Complaint regarding unclean drinking water supply.

• **Body:** I am writing to bring to your notice the unclean drinking water supply in our area. For the past two weeks, the water has been muddy and foul-smelling, and residents have reported cases of diarrhoea and typhoid. The water is unfit for drinking, cooking, and washing, and it has badly affected the health and daily life of the residents, especially children and the elderly. I request you to take urgent action to ensure access to clean and safe water in our area.

• **Closing:** I hope this matter will be treated as urgent. Yours sincerely, [Name].

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